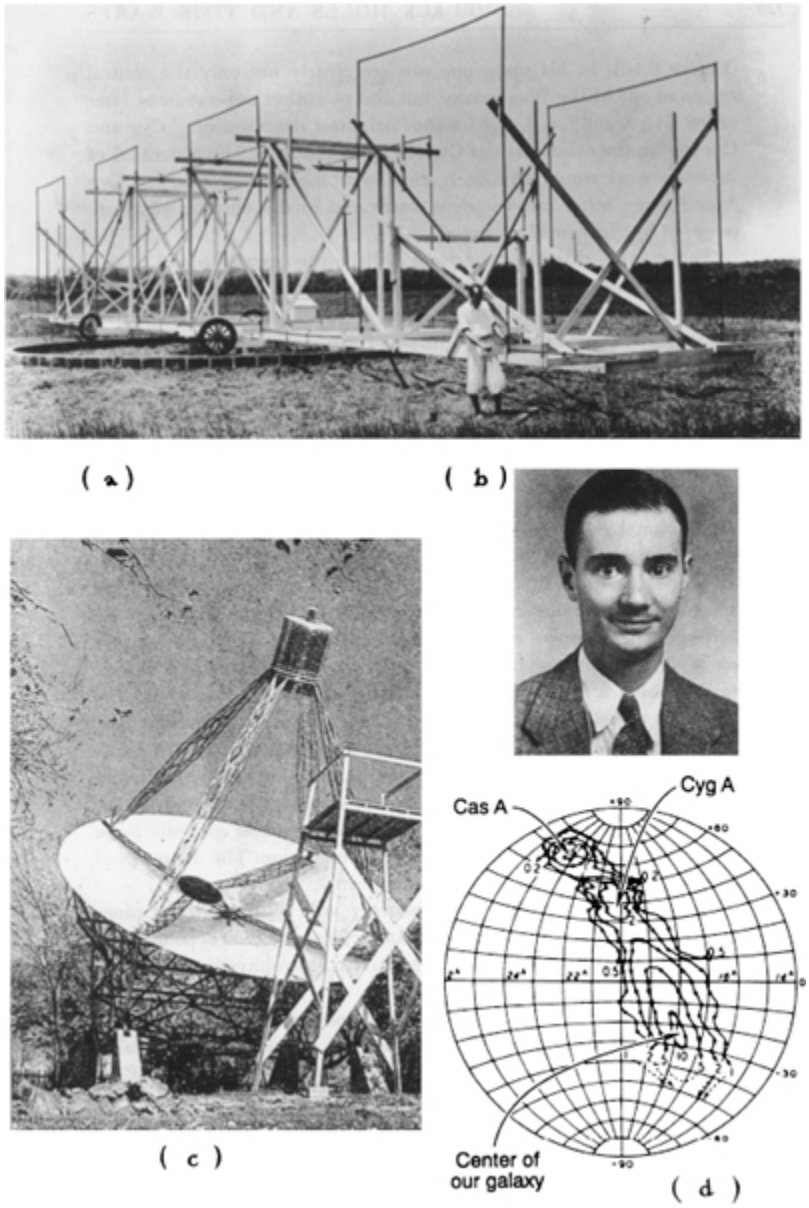
and many other radio sources discovered in the ensuing years are powered by gigantic black holes.



9.1 (a) Karl Jansky and the antenna with which he discovered, in 1932, cosmic radio waves from our galaxy. (b) Grote Reber, ca 1940. (c) The world's first radio telescope, constructed by Reber in his mother's backyard in Wheaton, Illinois. (d) A map of radio waves from the sky constructed by Reber with his backyard radio telescope. [(a) Photo by Bell Telephone Laboratories, courtesy AIP Emilio Segrè Visual Archives; (b) and (c) courtesy Grote Reber; (d) is adapted from Reber (1944).]

The story of this detective work will be the central thread of this chapter. I have chosen to devote a whole chapter to the story for several reasons: